

India's PRIVATE HOSPITAL Boom

INDIA'S HOSPITAL CHAINS ARE RACING TO ADD BEDS, RAISE CAPITAL, AND EXPAND ACROSS THE COUNTRY. INSURANCE IS BRINGING MORE PATIENTS INTO THE FORMAL HEALTHCARE SYSTEM, WHILE INVESTORS ARE POURING IN BILLIONS. WILL IT MAKE QUALITY HEALTHCARE MORE ACCESSIBLE OR SIMPLY MORE EXPENSIVE?

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pitals have attracted ₹55,000-60,000 crore through private equity and public markets since FY22, including nearly ₹25,000 crore in FY25 and FY26. The country's leading hospital chains are expected to invest another ₹40,000 crore to add more than 38,000 beds by 2030.

BEDS, BILLIONS AND BUILDING SPREE

The expansion is taking different forms. Some groups are building greenfield facilities, others are acquiring regional chains, while several are tapping public markets to strengthen balance sheets and finance future growth.

Temasek-backed Manipal Health Enterprises, India's largest private hospital network by bed capacity,

opened its ₹9,275-crore initial public offering in July. A large share of the proceeds will be used to reduce debt from acquisitions, including Columbia Asia, Vikram Hospital, Medica and Sahyadri Hospitals. "Three factors will drive our growth—increasing occupancy from the current 65%, adding new beds and unlocking the potential of Sahyadri Hospitals," says Managing Director and CEO Dilip Jose. Chief Financial Officer Samir Agarwal says the IPO will leave the company "practically" net debt free, giving it greater financial flexibility for future expansion.

Apollo Hospitals, by contrast, is relying largely on internal accruals. It plans to add nearly 4,400 beds over the next five years.